Week 1: Top 5 Grant Opportunities

Arborbrook Christian Academy

Report Date: November 22, 2025

Reporting Period: Week 1 of Weekly Delivery

Focus: 5 Highest-Priority Athletic Equipment & Program Opportunities

Total Potential Funding: $16,250 - $80,000

Urgent Deadlines: 2 requiring action by December 31, 2025

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Executive Summary

Urgent Action Alerts

Alert Level	Funder	Deadline	Action Required
CRITICAL	Walmart Spark	December 31,	Register TODAY at walmart.com/nonprofits; Begin

Alert Level	Funder	Deadline	Action Required
	Good	2025	DEED verification
CRITICAL	Neeb Family Foundation	December 31, 2025	Submit online inquiry at neebff.org/lp-apply/
HIGH	DICK'S Sports Matter	February 5, 2026	Begin document preparation now
HIGH	FFTC Longleaf Fund	March 11, 2026	Monitor for application opening
MEDIUM	Lorenz Family Foundation	Rolling	Submit Letter of Inquiry when ready

Funding Scenarios

Scenario	Opportunities Won	Projected Funding	Probability
Conservative	2 of 5	$6,250 - $30,000	High (70%+)
Moderate	3 of 5	$11,250 - $45,000	Medium (50%)
Ambitious	5 of 5	$16,250 - $80,000	Lower (30%)

Key Strengths of This Week's Batch

- **Faith-Based Alignment:** 3 of 5 opportunities explicitly fund faith-based organizations or Christian schools (Neeb, Lorenz, Walmart accepts faith-based)
- **Athletic Equipment Focus:** 4 of 5 opportunities fund athletic equipment purchases directly
- **NC Geographic Proximity:** FFTC Longleaf Fund explicitly serves Mecklenburg County; local Walmart stores in Matthews area
- **Deadline Distribution:** 2 urgent (December), 2 Q1 2026, 1 rolling - manageable application schedule

Success Path Recommendation

1. **Week of Nov 22-28:** Create Walmart account, begin Neeb inquiry form
2. **Week of Dec 1-15:** Submit Walmart applications to multiple stores, finalize Neeb materials
3. **Week of Dec 16-31:** SUBMIT both urgent applications before December 31 deadline
4. **January 2026:** Shift focus to DICK'S Sports Matter preparation
5. **February-March 2026:** Submit DICK'S and FFTC Longleaf applications

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About Arborbrook Christian Academy

Mission & Focus

Arborbrook Christian Academy is a K-12 Christian school located in Matthews, North Carolina (Mecklenburg County), committed to providing Christ-centered education that develops the whole child - academically, spiritually, and physically. The athletics program is an integral part of this mission, using sports as a vehicle for character development, faith formation, and physical wellness.

Grant Funding Goals

Parameter	Detail
Target Funding Range	$5,000 - $25,000 per grant
Geographic Location	Matthews, NC (Mecklenburg County)
Primary Focus	K-12 Athletics Programs
Funding Priorities	Athletic equipment, program support, facility improvements

Week 1 Focus Criteria

This week's 5 opportunities were selected based on:

Deadline Urgency: 2 opportunities closing December 31, 2025

Mission Alignment: Strong fit with Christian education and youth athletics

Funding Range: All within target $5K-$25K range (with Walmart as accessible entry point)

Application Complexity: Mix of quick-win (Walmart) and comprehensive (Neeb, DICK'S)

Geographic Eligibility: NC/Charlotte area funders prioritized

Note on Dual Positioning

Arborbrook must navigate three distinct funder audiences:

Funder Type	Lead With	This Week's Opportunities
Faith-Based	Christian mission, faith formation, discipleship	Neeb Family Foundation, Lorenz Family Foundation
Corporate/Secular	Community impact, youth development, access	Walmart Spark Good, DICK'S Sports Matter
Regional	Local community benefit, capital improvements	FFTC Longleaf Fund

Detailed positioning strategies are provided for each opportunity below.

Week 1 Opportunities Overview

Top 5 At-a-Glance

#	Funder	Amount	Deadline	Fit Score	Status
1	Walmart Spark Good	$250-$5,000/store	Dec 31, 2025	8/10	URGENT
2	Neeb Family Foundation	$5,000-$25,000	Dec 31, 2025	10/10	URGENT
3	DICK'S Sports Matter	$5,000-$15,000	Feb 5-May 30, 2026	9/10	HIGH
4	FFTC Longleaf Fund	$5,000-$25,000	March 11, 2026	8/10	HIGH
5	Lorenz Family Foundation	$1,000-$10,000	Rolling	9/10	MEDIUM

Total Potential Range: $16,250 - $80,000

Selection Methodology

From all validated opportunities in your comprehensive report, these 5 were prioritized based on:

1. **Deadline Proximity:** December deadlines receive highest priority
2. **Fit Score:** Minimum 8/10 alignment with Arborbrook's mission and needs
3. **Application Readiness:** Opportunities where Arborbrook can apply immediately
4. **Strategic Value:** Mix of quick wins and larger strategic grants
5. **Funder Type Diversity:** Balance of faith-based, corporate, and regional funders

Common Themes

- **Athletic Equipment Funding:** 4 of 5 explicitly fund equipment purchases
- **Faith-Based Eligibility:** 3 of 5 explicitly welcome or prioritize faith-based organizations
- **Youth Development Focus:** All 5 prioritize youth-serving programs
- **501(c)(3) Required:** All 5 require confirmed tax-exempt status (Arborbrook qualifies)

Opportunity #1: Walmart Spark Good Local Community Grants

Overview

Field	Detail
Amount	$250 - $5,000 per store
Deadline	December 31, 2025 (current cycle)
Status	**URGENT - ACT IMMEDIATELY**
Fit Score	8/10
Application URL	walmart.com/nonprofits

Why This Opportunity

Walmart Spark Good is an accessible entry point for grant funding with relatively simple application requirements. Key advantages:

- **Multiple Applications Allowed:** Up to 25 store requests per year
- **Local Decision Making:** Store managers decide awards (relationship building opportunity)
- **Equipment Focus:** Athletic equipment is eligible expense
- **Quick Turnaround:** Quarterly review cycles
- **Low Competition:** Many eligible nonprofits don't know about this program

Funder Overview

Category	Details
Funder	Walmart Foundation
Program	Spark Good Local Community Grants
Focus Areas	Youth development, community benefit, local impact

Category	Details
Award Cycle	Quarterly (Current: Nov 3 - Dec 31, 2025)
Decision Makers	Local store managers

Application Process

Step 1: Create Walmart.com Account (Day 1) - Go to walmart.com/nonprofits - Click "Get Started" button - Create account using organizational email (not personal) - Use official @arborbrook email address

Step 2: Access Spark Good Platform (Day 1) - Click "Access Spark Good" - Select "Add organization" to claim your profile - Enter EIN: 20-2707577

Step 3: Complete DEED Verification (Days 1-14) - DEED is Walmart's third-party verification partner - Submit required documentation for verification - Allow 1-2 weeks for verification to complete - Technical support: nonprofits@joindeed.com

Step 4: Set Up Payment Method (After Verification) - Navigate to Settings > Payments - Set up PayPal or Network for Good account - Required for fund receipt

Step 5: Submit Grant Applications (After Verification) - Apply to local Walmart stores in Matthews area - Each store can provide separate grant ($250-$5,000) - Target multiple stores: Matthews, Indian Trail, Mint Hill, Monroe

Required Documents Checklist

- ☐ IRS 501(c)(3) determination letter
- ☐ Organizational email address
- ☐ PayPal account for fund receipt
- ☐ Brief program description (equipment needs)

Key Contacts

Contact	Information
Spark Good Support	sparkgoodsupport@walmart.com
DEED Verification	nonprofits@joindeed.com
Portal	walmart.com/nonprofits

Positioning Strategy

For Walmart (Corporate Funder):

Lead With:

- Community benefit and youth development
- Local Matthews community impact
- Number of students and families served

- Accessible youth programming
- Removing barriers to sports participation

Language to Use:

- "Youth development through athletics"
- "Community access to organized sports"
- "Building healthy lifestyles"
- "Character development through teamwork"

Language to Avoid:

- Heavy religious messaging
- Evangelism language
- Denominational terminology

Sample Narrative: "Arborbrook Academy serves students in Matthews, NC through comprehensive K-12 athletics programming. Our sports programs develop character, leadership, and healthy lifestyles while removing barriers to participation for local families. Equipment funding will directly support student-athletes across multiple sports, expanding access to organized team activities in our community."

Funder Intelligence

- Walmart Foundation has given over $1.5 billion to local communities
- Local store managers have discretion over awards
- Faith-based organizations ARE eligible when serving community benefit
- Higher success rates for specific equipment requests vs. general operating

Application Tips

1. **Keep Ask Simple:** Request specific equipment (balls, uniforms, safety gear)
2. **Be Specific:** Name exact items and costs
3. **Local Impact:** Emphasize Matthews community benefit
4. **Apply to Multiple Stores:** Each store is separate opportunity
5. **Build Relationships:** Visit local stores to introduce your organization

Estimated Time Investment

Task	Time Required
Account creation	30 minutes
DEED verification	1-2 weeks (waiting)
Application per store	30-45 minutes
Total Active Time	3-4 hours

Opportunity #2: Neeb Family Foundation

Overview

Field	Detail
Amount	$5,000 - $25,000
Deadline	December 31, 2025
Status	**URGENT - WINDOW CLOSING**
Fit Score	10/10 (HIGHEST MATCH)
Application URL	neebff.org/lp-apply/

Why This Opportunity

Neeb Family Foundation represents the BEST FIT funder for Arborbrook Christian Academy:

- **Explicit Christian School Focus:** Foundation specifically supports Christian primary and secondary education
- **Denominational Flexibility:** While founders are Lutheran, NFF supports all Christian denominations
- **Equipment Eligible:** Technology, equipment, and facility improvements are funded
- **Significant Awards:** Up to $25,000 available
- **Values Alignment:** Can lead with Christian mission and faith formation

Funder Overview

Category	Details
Funder	Neeb Family Foundation
Founded	Lutheran family, serves all Christian denominations
Mission	Support Christian primary/secondary education, collegiate education, and outreach
Decision Timeline	Board meetings: Spring, Summer, or Fall 2026
Geographic Focus	National (no geographic restrictions)

Application Process

Step 1: Review Guidelines (Day 1)

- Visit neebff.org/lp-grant-faq/
- Confirm project aligns with funding priorities
- Note: They prefer capital/project grants over operating support

Step 2: Complete Online Inquiry Form (Days 1-3)

- Go to neebff.org/lp-apply/
- Complete all required fields
- Be comprehensive

- "the more information the better"
- Upload 501(c)(3) determination letter

Step 3: Foundation Contact (After Submission)

- Foundation representative will contact you
- Be prepared to provide additional project information
- Respond promptly to any requests

Step 4: Board Review (Spring/Summer/Fall 2026)

- Applications reviewed at board meetings
- Decision communicated after board meeting
- Awards disbursed upon approval

Required Documents Checklist

☐ IRS 501(c)(3) determination letter
☐ Detailed project description
☐ Project budget (itemized)
☐ Total project cost vs. amount requested
☐ Evidence of self-funding efforts (if applicable)
☐ Explanation of Christian education integration

Key Contacts

Contact	Information
Application Portal	neebff.org/lp-apply/
FAQ Page	neebff.org/lp-grant-faq/
General Inquiry	Via website contact form

Positioning Strategy

For Neeb Family Foundation (Faith-Based Funder):

LEAD WITH CHRISTIAN MISSION

This is a faith-based funder that explicitly supports Christian education. Your application should:

- Emphasize faith formation through athletics
- Connect sports to Christian character development
- Explain how athletics serves the school's Christian vision
- Highlight discipleship opportunities in team settings
- Frame athletics as ministry and stewardship of physical gifts

Language to Use:

- "Christ-centered athletics"
- "Faith formation through sports"
- "Biblical character development"
- "Discipleship and spiritual growth"
- "Glorifying God through athletics"
- "Whole-person Christian education"

Sample Narrative: "At Arborbrook Christian Academy, athletics is an integral part of our Christ-centered educational mission. Our sports programs provide daily opportunities for faith formation, teaching student-athletes to glorify God through their physical gifts, develop Biblical character through competition, and serve others with humility and grace. We believe athletics uniquely develops perseverance, teamwork, and integrity - virtues rooted in Scripture and essential to Christian discipleship. Funding for [specific equipment/project] will directly support this ministry to our student-athletes and their families."

What They Fund

Funded	Not Funded
Infrastructure repairs (HVAC, plumbing)	General operating budgets (rarely)
Technology upgrades (laptops, whiteboards)	Debt reduction
Equipment purchases	Financial aid/scholarships
Room/space buildouts	Capital campaigns
Vehicle purchases	

Application Tips

1. **Be Comprehensive:** "The more information the better" - provide thorough details
2. **Show Self-Funding:** Demonstrate you can contribute some funds yourself
3. **Project Focus:** Single project completion grants preferred
4. **Broad Impact:** Emphasize how project benefits most people over longest time
5. **Faith Integration:** Clearly connect project to Christian education mission

Estimated Time Investment

Task	Time Required
Guidelines review	1 hour
Inquiry form completion	2-3 hours
Document gathering	1-2 hours
Follow-up communications	1-2 hours
Total Active Time	5-8 hours

Opportunity #3: DICK'S Sporting Goods Sports Matter

Overview

Field	Detail
Amount	$5,000 - $15,000 (up to $25,000 possible)
Deadline	February 5 - May 30, 2026 (application window)
Status	**HIGH PRIORITY - Prepare Now**
Fit Score	9/10
Application URL	sportsmatter.org/s/apply-for-funding

Why This Opportunity

DICK'S Sports Matter is a major corporate funder with significant resources committed to youth sports:

- **$100M+ Committed:** DICK'S Foundation has committed over $100 million to youth sports
- **2M+ Youth Served:** Program has helped over 2 million young athletes since 2014
- **Equipment Focus:** Explicitly funds equipment, registration, and league costs
- **Brand Recognition:** Association with respected sports retailer
- **Substantial Awards:** Grants range from $1,000 to $25,000

Funder Overview

Category	Details
Funder	The DICK'S Sporting Goods Foundation
Program	Sports Matter
Launched	2014
Total Giving	$100M+ to youth sports
Youth Served	2M+ young athletes
Focus	Removing barriers to youth sports participation

Application Process

Step 1: Eligibility Confirmation (Now)

- Visit sportsmatter.org/s/grant-eligibility
- Confirm Arborbrook meets requirements:
    - U.S.-based 501(c)(3) nonprofit OR school sports team
    - Supports team youth sports
    - Helps youth from low-income families/communities
    - Provides organized sports for youth under 18

Step 2: Document Preparation (December-January)

- Gather required documents (see checklist below)
- Prepare program budget
- Compile participant demographics
- Document impact metrics

Step 3: Application Submission (February 5 - May 30, 2026)

- Visit sportsmatter.org/s/apply-for-funding when window opens
- Create account on application portal
- Complete online application with all supporting documents
- Submit before May 30, 2026 deadline

Step 4: Committee Review (After Submission)

- Applications reviewed by committee
- Looking for detail, clarity, and demonstrated impact
- Awards announced after review period

Required Documents Checklist

☐ 501(c)(3) determination letter
☐ Program budget (detailed, itemized)
☐ Participant demographics (gender, age, economic background)
☐ Impact metrics (students served, sports offered, participation rates)
☐ Community need documentation
☐ Access barrier identification

Key Contacts

Contact	Information
Application Portal	sportsmatter.org/s/apply-for-funding
Eligibility Info	sportsmatter.org/s/grant-eligibility
Program Information	sportsmatter.org

Positioning Strategy

For DICK'S Sports Matter (Corporate Funder):

LEAD WITH ACCESS AND COMMUNITY IMPACT

This is a corporate funder focused on removing barriers to sports. Your application should:

- Emphasize youth development outcomes
- Highlight number of students served

- Focus on removing barriers to participation
- Demonstrate community need
- Show diversity and inclusion efforts

Language to Use:

- "Youth development"
- "Community access"
- "Removing barriers to participation"
- "Inclusive programming"
- "Character and leadership development"
- "Healthy lifestyles through sports"

Language to Avoid:

- Heavy religious messaging
- Evangelism language
- Denominational terminology
- Scripture references

Sample Narrative: "Arborbrook Academy serves [X] students in Matthews, NC through comprehensive K-12 athletics programming. Our sports programs remove barriers to participation, develop character and leadership skills, and create pathways for youth to lead healthy, active lives. In 2024-25, our athletics department served [X] student-athletes across [X] sports, providing access to organized team sports regardless of family financial circumstances. Funding for [specific equipment] will expand our capacity to serve additional youth and enhance program quality."

What They Fund

Funded	Not Funded
Equipment purchases	Playground projects
Registration fees	E-sports programs
League costs	Travel expenses (typically)
Team uniforms	General operating
Safety gear	

Application Tips

1. **Detail and Clarity:** Committee looks for thorough, well-organized applications
2. **Demonstrate Impact:** Show clear benefit to constituents
3. **Community Specificity:** Explain how work strengthens local community
4. **Diversity Focus:** Highlight diversity and inclusion in programming
5. **Barrier Identification:** Clearly articulate access barriers you're addressing

6. **Avoid Religious Emphasis:** Focus on community benefit, not faith mission

Estimated Time Investment

Task	Time Required
Eligibility review	30 minutes
Document gathering	3-4 hours
Application completion	4-6 hours
Review and submission	1-2 hours
Total Active Time	8-12 hours

Opportunity #4: FFTC Longleaf Fund

Overview

Field	Detail
Amount	$5,000 - $25,000
Deadline	March 11, 2026 (predicted, based on 2025 cycle)
Status	**HIGH PRIORITY**
Fit Score	8/10
Application URL	fftcgrants.communityforce.com/Login.aspx

Why This Opportunity

FFTC Longleaf Fund is a regional funder with strong geographic alignment:

- **Mecklenburg County Eligible:** Matthews, NC is explicitly within funding geography
- **Capital Projects Focus:** Funds facilities and equipment for youth programs
- **Youth Development Priority:** Emphasis on at-risk children and youth
- **Substantial Awards:** $5,000 to $25,000 grants available
- **Local Foundation:** Foundation For The Carolinas has deep community roots

Funder Overview

Category	Details
Funder	Foundation For The Carolinas (Anonymous Donor Advised Fund)
Program	Longleaf Fund
Focus	Capital projects strengthening character and achievement of at-risk youth
Geographic Area	Carolinas, including Mecklenburg County
Application Window	January 28 - March 11, 2026 (predicted)

Application Process

Step 1: Monitor for Guidelines (January 2026)

- Visit fftcgrants.communityforce.com

- Watch for 2026 guidelines posting
- Sign up for FFTC grant announcements if available

Step 2: Confirm Eligibility (January 2026)

- Verify project aligns with priorities:
  - Building/enhancing space for play, sports, recreational activities
  - Promoting learning with emphasis on technology access
  - Enhancing quality of life for children ages 0-18
- Confirm capital project focus (not operational expenses)

Step 3: Contact Program Officer (January 2026)

- Reach out to Ayanna Wakefield Lutin (awlutin@fftc.org)
- Discuss project fit before applying
- Get guidance on application priorities

Step 4: Submit Application (February-March 2026)

- Complete online application by March 11, 2026
- Include all required documentation
- Ensure project can complete within 12-18 months

Required Documents Checklist

☐ 501(c)(3) determination letter OR educational institution documentation
☐ Project description (detailed scope)
☐ Project budget (itemized costs)
☐ Project timeline (12-18 month completion)
☐ Community benefit documentation
☐ Youth impact metrics

Key Contacts

Contact	Information
Program Contact	Ayanna Wakefield Lutin
Email	awlutin@fftc.org
Application Portal	fftcgrants.communityforce.com

Positioning Strategy

For FFTC Longleaf Fund (Regional Foundation):

LEAD WITH CAPITAL IMPROVEMENTS AND COMMUNITY BENEFIT

This is a regional foundation focused on capital projects. Your application should:

- Focus on capital improvements (facilities, fields, equipment)
- Emphasize community benefit and youth development
- Show measurable impact on at-risk youth
- Demonstrate project completion within 12-18 months
- Highlight Mecklenburg County community impact

Language to Use:

- "Capital improvement project"
- "Youth development infrastructure"
- "Community benefit"
- "Measurable outcomes"
- "Sustainable impact"

Language to Avoid:

- Religious advocacy language
- Denominational terminology
- Operational/ongoing expenses framing

Sample Narrative: "Arborbrook Academy seeks funding for [specific capital project] to enhance athletic programming for youth in Matthews, NC. This project will [specific improvement], directly benefiting [X] student-athletes annually. The capital investment will provide lasting community benefit with measurable outcomes in youth development, physical wellness, and character formation. Project completion is targeted for [timeline] with sustainable ongoing utilization."

Priority Areas

Priority	Description
Play & Recreation	Building/enhancing space for play, sports, recreational activities
Learning & Technology	Promoting learning with emphasis on technology access
Children with Disabilities	Enhancing quality of life for children 0-18 with disabilities

Application Tips

1. **Capital Focus:** Project must be capital, not operational
2. **Completion Timeline:** Must complete within 12-18 months of award
3. **Contact First:** Reach out to Ayanna before applying
4. **Community Language:** Avoid religious advocacy, focus on community benefit
5. **Measurable Outcomes:** Clearly articulate how impact will be measured

Estimated Time Investment

Task	Time Required
Guidelines review	1 hour
Program officer contact	1-2 hours
Application completion	4-6 hours
Documentation gathering	2-3 hours
Total Active Time	8-12 hours

Opportunity #5: Lorenz Family Foundation

Overview

Field	Detail
Amount	$1,000 - $10,000 (typical: $5,000-$10,000)
Deadline	Rolling (Letter of Inquiry); Awards ~May 1 annually
Status	**MEDIUM PRIORITY**
Fit Score	9/10
Application URL	lorenzfamilyfoundation.org

Why This Opportunity

Lorenz Family Foundation has explicit alignment with Christian school mission:

- **Christian School Focus:** Established specifically to support Christian schools
- **Explicit Eligibility:** Christian elementary and secondary schools given priority
- **Faith Requirement:** Must acknowledge Trinitarian faith (perfect fit for Arborbrook)
- **Innovation Valued:** Looks for creative, reproducible projects
- **Rolling Timeline:** Flexibility in submission timing

Funder Overview

Category	Details
Funder	Lorenz Family Foundation
Founded	1999 by Christian educator Don Lorenz
Mission	Support and enhance Christian educational opportunities
Focus	Christian elementary and secondary schools
Award Timeline	Awards announced ~May 1 annually

Application Process

Step 1: Review Guidelines (Now)

- Visit lorenzfamilyfoundation.org
- Understand funding priorities and requirements

- Note Trinitarian faith acknowledgment requirement

Step 2: Prepare Letter of Inquiry (December-January)

- Draft compelling Letter of Inquiry
- Include project description, budget, faith integration
- Demonstrate innovative/reproducible aspects

Step 3: Submit Letter of Inquiry (Any Time)

- Submit via website or mail
- Letters accepted year-round
- Foundation reviews and responds

Step 4: Full Application (If Invited)

- Complete full application if invited to proceed
- Provide comprehensive project documentation
- Await board review

Step 5: Award Decision (~May 1)

- Board reviews applications annually
- Awards announced approximately May 1
- Prepare to share results with other Christian schools

Required Documents Checklist

☐ Letter of Inquiry (project description)
☐ 501(c)(3) determination letter (EIN: 20-2707577)
☐ Project budget (minimum $5,000 request)
☐ Evidence of broader impact potential
☐ Trinitarian faith acknowledgment
☐ Plan to share results with other Christian schools

Key Contacts

Contact	Information
General Inquiry	Website contact form
Phone	503-222-1161
Website	lorenzfamilyfoundation.org

Positioning Strategy

For Lorenz Family Foundation (Faith-Based Funder):

LEAD WITH CHRISTIAN MISSION AND TRINITARIAN COMMITMENT

This foundation has explicit Christian requirements. Your application should:

- Emphasize Trinitarian faith commitment clearly
- Show how athletics develops Christian character
- Highlight innovative or reproducible aspects
- Connect to faith formation and discipleship
- Demonstrate willingness to share with other Christian schools

Language to Use:

- "Trinitarian faith" (God the Father as Creator, God the Son as Redeemer, God the Holy Spirit as Sanctifier)
- "Christian education mission"
- "Faith formation through athletics"
- "Reproducible programming"
- "Kingdom impact beyond our school"

Special Requirement: Must be willing to share project results with other Christian schools - frame project as benefiting broader Christian education community.

Sample Narrative: "Arborbrook Christian Academy, committed to Trinitarian Christian faith, seeks support for an innovative athletics initiative that develops Christian character through sports. Our project [specific description] will provide a reproducible model that can benefit Christian schools beyond our campus. We acknowledge God the Father as Creator, God the Son as Redeemer, and God the Holy Spirit as Sanctifier, and seek to glorify the Triune God through athletics that forms disciples of Christ. We commit to sharing our project outcomes and methodologies with the broader Christian school community."

What They Fund

Funded	Not Funded
Innovative, creative projects	Ongoing operational expenditures
Projects developing Christian growth	Capital campaigns
Reproducible programs	Projects under $5,000
Projects with broader impact	

Application Tips

1. **Trinitarian Explicit:** Clearly acknowledge Trinitarian faith
2. **Innovation Focus:** Highlight creative, entrepreneurial aspects
3. **Reproducibility:** Show how project can benefit other Christian schools

4. **Minimum Request:** Projects must be $5,000+ (smaller requests not considered)
5. **Sharing Commitment:** Express willingness to share results broadly

Estimated Time Investment

Task	Time Required
Guidelines review	1 hour
Letter of Inquiry drafting	3-4 hours
Document gathering	1-2 hours
Full application (if invited)	4-6 hours
Total Active Time	9-13 hours

Comprehensive Timeline

Week of November 22-28, 2025

Day	Action Item	Priority	Time
Nov 22 (Fri)	Create Walmart Spark Good account at walmart.com/nonprofits	URGENT	30 min
Nov 22 (Fri)	Begin DEED verification process	URGENT	30 min
Nov 23-24	Review Neeb Family Foundation guidelines at neebff.org	HIGH	1 hr
Nov 25	Begin drafting Neeb inquiry form responses	HIGH	2 hrs
Nov 26-28	Continue Neeb application preparation	HIGH	2 hrs

Week of November 29 - December 5, 2025

Day	Action Item	Priority	Time
Nov 29-30	Complete Neeb inquiry form draft	HIGH	2 hrs
Dec 1-2	Follow up on DEED verification if not complete	URGENT	30 min
Dec 3-4	Finalize Neeb application materials	HIGH	2 hrs
Dec 5	Submit Neeb Family Foundation inquiry	HIGH	1 hr

Week of December 6-12, 2025

Day	Action Item	Priority	Time
Dec 6-7	Confirm DEED verification complete	URGENT	30 min
Dec 8-9	Identify local Walmart stores for applications	HIGH	1 hr
Dec 10-11	Draft Walmart grant application narrative	HIGH	2 hrs
Dec 12	Submit first Walmart store application	HIGH	45 min

Week of December 13-20, 2025

Day	Action Item	Priority	Time
Dec 13-14	Submit additional Walmart store applications	HIGH	2 hrs

Day	Action Item	Priority	Time
Dec 15-16	Respond to any Neeb follow-up requests	HIGH	As needed
Dec 17-18	Review Lorenz Family Foundation guidelines	MEDIUM	1 hr
Dec 19-20	Begin drafting Lorenz Letter of Inquiry	MEDIUM	2 hrs

Week of December 21-31, 2025 (CRITICAL)

Day	Action Item	Priority	Time
Dec 21-23	Final review of Walmart applications	CRITICAL	1 hr
Dec 24-26	Holiday break	-	-
Dec 27-28	Ensure all Walmart applications submitted	CRITICAL	1 hr
Dec 29-30	Finalize any remaining Neeb materials	CRITICAL	2 hrs
Dec 31	**DEADLINE: Walmart Q4 cycle closes**	**CRITICAL**	-
Dec 31	**DEADLINE: Neeb application window closes**	**CRITICAL**	-

January 2026

Week	Action Item	Priority
Jan 1-7	Begin DICK'S Sports Matter preparation	HIGH
Jan 8-14	Gather DICK'S required documents (demographics, budget)	HIGH
Jan 15-21	Monitor FFTC Longleaf Fund for 2026 guidelines	HIGH
Jan 22-28	Contact FFTC program officer (Ayanna Wakefield Lutin)	HIGH
Jan 28 (est)	FFTC Longleaf Fund application window opens	HIGH

February-March 2026

Date	Action Item	Priority
Feb 5	DICK'S Sports Matter application window OPENS	HIGH
Feb 5-15	Complete and submit DICK'S application	HIGH
Feb 15-28	Begin FFTC Longleaf Fund application	HIGH
Mar 1-10	Finalize FFTC Longleaf Fund application	HIGH
Mar 11	**DEADLINE: FFTC Longleaf Fund (predicted)**	**CRITICAL**
Mar 15-31	Monitor for Lorenz Foundation decision (~May 1)	MEDIUM

At-a-Glance Deadline Calendar

Month	Deadline	Funder	Amount
December 2025	Dec 31	Walmart Spark Good	$250-$5,000
December 2025	Dec 31	Neeb Family Foundation	$5,000-$25,000
February 2026	Feb 5	DICK'S Sports Matter (opens)	$5,000-$15,000
March 2026	Mar 11	FFTC Longleaf Fund	$5,000-$25,000
May 2026	May 1	Lorenz Foundation (awards)	$1,000-$10,000
May 2026	May 30	DICK'S Sports Matter (closes)	$5,000-$15,000

Quick Reference Appendix

All Contacts

Funder	Contact Name	Email	Phone	Website
Walmart Spark Good	Support Team	sparkgoodsupport@walmart.com	-	walmart.com/nonprofits
DEED Verification	Support Team	nonprofits@joindeed.com	-	-
Neeb Family Foundation	General Inquiry	Via website	-	neebff.org
DICK'S Sports Matter	General Inquiry	Via website	-	sportsmatter.org
FFTC Longleaf Fund	Ayanna Wakefield Lutin	awlutin@fftc.org	-	fftcgrants.communityforce.com
Lorenz Family Foundation	General Inquiry	Via website	503-222-1161	lorenzfamilyfoundation.org

All Deadlines by Month

Month	Deadlines
November 2025	Begin applications (no deadlines)
December 2025	Walmart Spark Good (Dec 31), Neeb Family Foundation (Dec 31)
January 2026	FFTC Longleaf opens (~Jan 28)
February 2026	DICK'S Sports Matter opens (Feb 5)
March 2026	FFTC Longleaf Fund (Mar 11)
May 2026	Lorenz awards (~May 1), DICK'S closes (May 30)

Common Documents Needed

Document	Walmart	Neeb	DICK'S	FFTC	Lorenz
501(c)(3) Letter	Required	Required	Required	Required	Required
EIN	Required	Required	Required	Required	Required
W-9	-	-	-	-	-
Program Budget	-	Required	Required	Required	Required
Project Budget	-	Required	-	Required	Required
Board List	-	Optional	-	-	-

Document	Walmart	Neeb	DICK'S	FFTC	Lorenz
Demographics	-	-	Required	Optional	-
Impact Metrics	-	Optional	Required	Required	Optional
Faith Statement	-	Helpful	Avoid	Avoid	Required

Portal Quick Links

Funder	Direct Application Link
Walmart Spark Good	walmart.com/nonprofits
Neeb Family Foundation	neebff.org/lp-apply/
DICK'S Sports Matter	sportsmatter.org/s/apply-for-funding
FFTC Longleaf Fund	fftcgrants.communityforce.com
Lorenz Family Foundation	lorenzfamilyfoundation.org

Document Preparation Checklist

Standard Documents (All Applications)

☐ **IRS 501(c)(3) Determination Letter**
- Shows EIN:
- PDF format, readily accessible
- Multiple copies saved in cloud storage

☐ **Current Fiscal Year Budget**
- Total organizational budget
- Athletics program budget breakdown
- PDF and editable versions

☐ **Board of Directors List**
- Names and professional affiliations
- May include brief bios

Program Documents

☐ **Athletics Program Overview**
- Number of sports offered
- Number of student-athletes served
- Grade levels (K-12)
- Facilities description
- Coaching staff overview

☐ **Participant Demographics**
- Total students served
- Gender breakdown (boys/girls)
- Grade level distribution
- Economic diversity data (if available)

☐ **Program Impact Metrics**
- Year-over-year participation growth
- Student outcomes (academic, character)
- Retention rates
- Testimonials (optional)

Application-Specific Documents

For Walmart Spark Good:

[ ] PayPal account setup

[ ] Organizational email (not personal)

[ ] Local store list with addresses

For Neeb Family Foundation:

[ ] Detailed project description

[ ] Christian mission integration narrative

[ ] Self-funding evidence (if applicable)

For DICK'S Sports Matter:

[ ] Access barrier documentation

[ ] Community need assessment

[ ] Diversity and inclusion statement

For FFTC Longleaf Fund:

[ ] Capital project scope document

[ ] 12-18 month project timeline

[ ] Sustainability plan

For Lorenz Family Foundation:

[ ] Trinitarian faith statement

[ ] Innovation/reproducibility description

[ ] Plan to share with other Christian schools

Dual Positioning Documents

Faith-Based Version (Neeb, Lorenz):

[ ] Christian mission statement

[ ] Faith formation through athletics narrative

[ ] Discipleship outcomes documentation

[ ] Chapel/devotional integration description

Corporate/Secular Version (Walmart, DICK'S, FFTC):

[ ] Community impact statement

[ ] Youth development outcomes

[ ] Access and inclusion narrative

[ ] Character development (non-religious framing)

Document Storage Recommendation

Create organized folder structure:

```
Arborbrook Grant Documents/
├── Core Documents/
│   ├── 501c3_Determination_Letter.pdf
│   ├── EIN_Documentation.pdf
│   ├── W9_Current.pdf
│   └── Board_List.pdf
├── Budgets/
│   ├── FY2025_Organizational_Budget.pdf
│   ├── Athletics_Program_Budget.pdf
│   └── Project_Budgets/
├── Program Information/
│   ├── Athletics_Overview.pdf
│   ├── Demographics_Data.xlsx
│   └── Impact_Metrics.pdf
├── Narratives/
│   ├── Faith_Based_Version.docx
│   └── Corporate_Version.docx
└── Applications/
    ├── Walmart/
    ├── Neeb/
    ├── DICKS/
    ├── FFTC/
    └── Lorenz/
```

Conclusion

Week 1 Success Path

This week's 5 opportunities represent the highest-priority grant possibilities for Arborbrook Christian Academy based on deadline urgency, mission alignment, and funding potential. Success requires:

1. **Immediate Action:** Two deadlines (Walmart, Neeb) require submissions by December 31, 2025

2. **Dual Positioning:** Adapt messaging for faith-based vs. corporate funders
3. **Document Readiness:** Prepare core documents that serve multiple applications
4. **Timeline Discipline:** Follow the week-by-week action plan provided

Immediate Next Steps

1. ☐ **TODAY:** Create Walmart Spark Good account at walmart.com/nonprofits
2. ☐ **THIS WEEK:** Begin DEED verification and Neeb inquiry form
3. ☐ **BY DEC 15:** Submit first Walmart store application(s)
4. ☐ **BY DEC 31:** Complete BOTH Walmart and Neeb applications before deadline

Feedback Request

Your feedback directly improves future reports. Please complete the attached 2-minute feedback form covering:

- Which opportunities you plan to pursue
- What information was most/least helpful
- How we can improve the weekly format

Questions or Support

For questions about any opportunity in this week's report, contact:

Email: alec@kleinmanventures.com

Response Time: Within 24-48 hours

Next Week Preview

- Week 2 will feature 5 additional opportunities from your opportunity pipeline, including:
- Carolina Panthers Charities (when 2026 cycle opens)
- Duke Energy Foundation
- NC Youth Sports Grant
- Additional sport-specific opportunities

Report Prepared: November 22, 2025

TheGrantScout Research Team

This report should be reviewed weekly and updated as application statuses change.